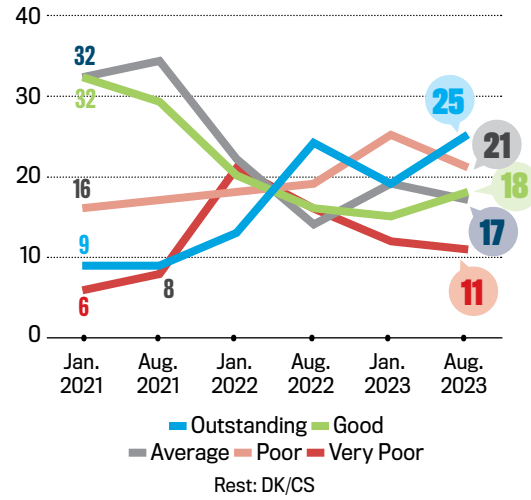
On August 20, the 79th birth anniversary of former prime minister Rajiv Gandhi, Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge announced the formation of the Congress Working Committee (CWC), the highest decision-making body of the party. In recent Congress history, it was the longest time—10 months—that a party president had taken to form the CWC after election or selection as the head of the Grand Old Party. Kharge was elected Congress president in October 2022, which was ratified at the party plenary in Raipur in February this year.

Perhaps the octogenarian Kharge—in the Congress for more than five decades—was waiting for the right moment to unveil the team that would help him fight the Prime Minister Narendra Modi-led BJP in arguably the biggest battle of his political career—the 2024 Lok Sabha election. And the timing could not have been better. Under Kharge's leadership, the party has won two assembly elections—in Himachal Pradesh and Karnataka—in a span of six months. In Karnataka, prestige was at stake as it is Kharge's home state.

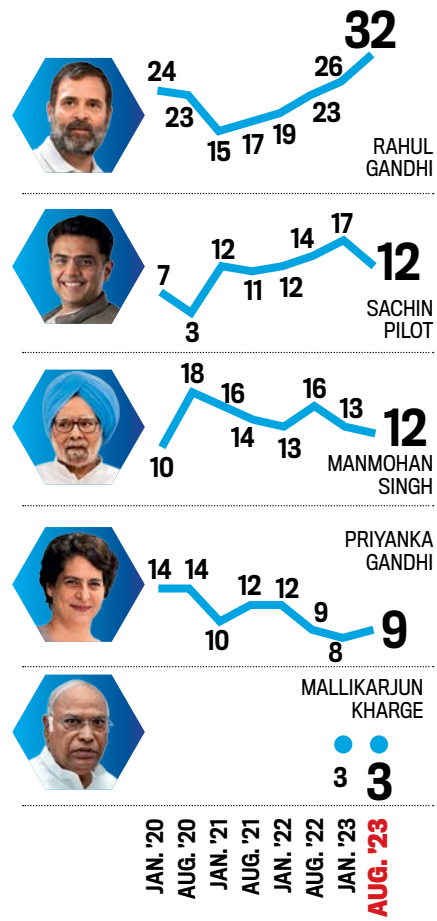
He has also played a key role not only in building an Opposition alliance, now called INDIA (Indian National Developmental Inclusive Alliance), but also in making allies such as the West Bengal chief minister Mamata Banerjee-led Trinamool Congress (TMC) and the Delhi chief minister Arvind Kejriwal-led Aam Aadmi Party (AAP)

Q. How would you rate the performance of the Congress as an Opposition party?



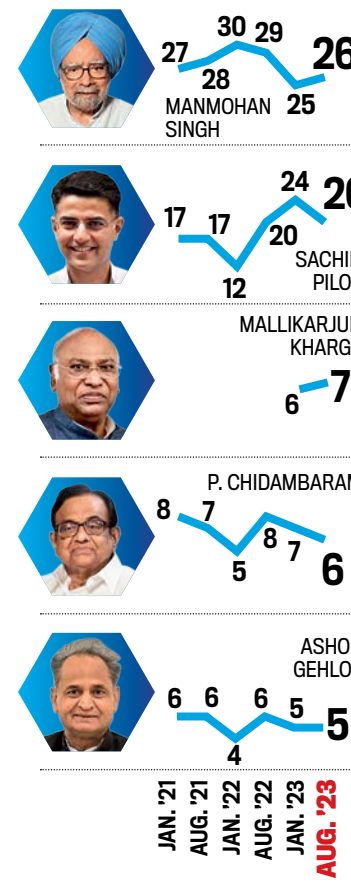
More than 43 per cent of the respondents rate the Congress party's performance as outstanding or good this time, compared to 34 per cent in January 2023

Q. Which Congress leader is best suited to revive the party?



In the highest approval in the past four years, 32 per cent say Rahul is best suited to revive the Congress

Q. Who among the non-Gandhi leaders is best suited to lead the Congress?



Manmohan Singh is the most trusted among the non-Gandhis to lead the Congress

All figures in % and rounded off; DK/CS (don't know/can't say)